



How to use positional parameters

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All command line parameters (positional parameters) are available via special shell variable \$1, \$2, \$3,....,\$9.

How Do I Access Command-Line Arguments

Create a simple shell script called cmdargs.sh:

```
#!/bin/bash
echo "The script name : $0"
echo "The value of the first argument to the script : $1"
echo "The value of the second argument to the script : $2"
echo "The value of the third argument to the script : $3"
echo "The number of arguments passed to the script : $#"
```

Save and close the file. Rut it as follows:

```
chmod +x cmdargs.sh
./cmdargs.sh bmw ford toyota
```

Sample outputs:

```
The script name : ./cmdargs.sh
The value of the first argument to the script : bmw
The value of the second argument to the script : ford
The value of the third argument to the script : toyota
The number of arguments passed to the script : 3
The value of all command-line arguments ($* version) : bmw ford toyota
The value of all command-line arguments ($@ version) : bmw ford toyota
```

Try the following examples:

```
ls /tmp
./math 10 + 3
~/scripts/addzone cyberciti.com
~/scripts/adddomain cyberciti.biz '74.86.48.99' '2607:f0d0:1002:11::4'
/etc/init.d/named reload
/usr/local/etc/rc.d/jail restart cyberciti.biz
```

Shell script name (\$0)	Total number of arguments (\$#)	Actual Command line argument (\$1,...,\$9)
ls	1	/tmp
./math	3	10, +, and 3
~/scripts/addzone	1	cyberciti.com
~/scripts/adddomain	3	cyberciti.biz, 74.86.48.99, and 2607:f0d0:1002:11::4
/etc/init.d/named reload	1	reload
/usr/local/etc/rc.d/jail	2	restart, and cyberciti.biz

A Note About \$@ and \$*

- \$@ expanded as "\$1" "\$2" "\$3" ... "\$n"
- \$* expanded as "\$1\$2\$3y...\$n", where y is the value of \$IFS variable i.e. "\$*" is one long string and \$IFS act as an separator or token delimiters.

Example: The Difference Between \$@ and \$*

Create a shell script called pizza.sh:

```
#!/bin/bash
IFS=", "
echo "* Displaying all pizza names using $@"
echo "$@"

echo "* Displaying all pizza names using $*"
echo "$*"
```

Save and close the file. Run it as follows:

```
chmod +x pizza.sh
./pizza.sh Margherita Tomato Panner Gourmet
```

Sample outputs:

```
* Displaying all pizza names using $@
Margherita Tomato Panner Gourmet

*Displaying all pizza names using $*
Margherita,Tomato,Panner,Gourmet
```

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